

# Seasonal Calendar

ChatGPT edition

Phenology, not a guarantee

| Period                 | Starting hypothesis                                                         | Evidence to seek                                                   |
|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ice-out / early spring | Protected shallows may warm first; pike and panfish may use emerging cover. | Temperature difference, green growth, bait and legal season.       |
| Late spring            | Spawning and post-spawn movement can concentrate fish shallow.              | Beds, recovering fish, water temperature; avoid damaging nests.    |
| Early summer           | Vegetation edges and hard-bottom breaks develop.                            | Actual weed depth, insect activity and repeated contact depth.     |
| Mid-summer             | Some fish use deep edges or suspend; oxygen can constrain usable depth.     | Thermocline/oxygen evidence, bait height, warm-water release risk. |
| Early fall             | Cooling can redistribute forage and predators.                              | Turnover signs, temperature uniformity, wind and bait.             |
| Late fall              | Slow, depth-controlled presentations often become useful.                   | Bottom contact, short feeding windows, cold-water safety.          |
| Ice season             | Tip-ups and small vertical lures can cover lawful targets.                  | Current local ice assessment; avoid inlets, outlets and narrows.   |

CALENDAR DOES NOT OPEN A SEASON

For 2026–27, resolve the exact water, species and date in current Wisconsin DNR rules. No date, appearance or reported thickness makes ice completely safe.

Source basis: Wisconsin DNR season dates, Hook Your Catch and Ice Safety.

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